

Introduction to Research & Thesis Writing

Course Focus: Academic Excellence and Systematic Inquiry

Level: Advanced Undergraduate / Graduate

Course Description

Let's be honest: writing a thesis can feel overwhelming. This course breaks down the "academic monster" into manageable steps. We'll move from "I have a vague idea" to a "solid, defensible research proposal." You'll learn how to find gaps in existing literature and how to argue your points with academic rigour and integrity.

What You'll Learn

- Formulating a clear, punchy **Research Question**.
- Mastering the **Literature Review** (without getting lost in PDFs).
- Understanding Qualitative vs. Quantitative **Methodologies**.
- Academic Ethics and Citation (APA/MLA/IEEE).

Weekly Breakdown

- **Week 1: The Research Mindset** – What makes a "good" topic? Ethics and Plagiarism.
- **Week 2: The Literature Review** – Search strategies, organizing sources, and identifying "The Gap."
- **Week 3: Problem Statement & Objectives** – Defining exactly what you are trying to solve.
- **Week 4: Methodology (Part A)** – Quantitative methods: Surveys, Experiments, and Statistics.
- **Week 5: Methodology (Part B)** – Qualitative methods: Interviews, Case Studies, and Thematic Analysis.
- **Week 6: Data Collection & Tools** – Using tools like Zotero (citations), SPSS/R (data), or NVivo (qualitative).
- **Week 7: Structuring the Thesis** – Drafting the Introduction, Results, and Discussion chapters.
- **Week 8: The Finishing Touches** – Abstract writing, formatting, and preparing for the Viva/Defense.

Course Outcome

A completed **Research Proposal** (approx. 3,000 words) ready for supervisor approval.